

Elysa Ward

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Summary

Frontend engineer building fast, accessible interfaces with TypeScript and React. Quick to pick up new frameworks, with a focus on code that is tested, readable, and genuinely useful to the people who use it. A Mathematics background provides a strong analytical foundation, paired with a love of collaborative teams that value learning and clear communication.

Technical Skills

Languages/Frameworks:

TypeScript, JavaScript, React.js, Vue.js, Node.js, Next.js, HTML5, CSS, Ruby on Rails, Python

Frontend & UI:

Responsive Design, Cross-Browser Compatibility, WCAG Accessibility Standards, Design Systems, Component Libraries, Web Performance Optimization, Tailwind CSS, CSS Modules, Figma

API, Data, & Cloud:

RESTful APIs, API Integration, JSON, XML, PostgreSQL, MySQL, Redis, SQLite, DynamoDB, AWS (Amplify, serverless), Heroku, Render

Testing & Quality:

Test Driven Development (TDD), Unit Testing, Integration Testing, Cypress, Playwright, RSpec, FactoryBot, Code Reviews

Practices & Methodologies:

Agile/Scrum, CI/CD Automation (GitHub Actions, CircleCI), Observability & Monitoring, Pair Programming, Error Handling & Retry Logic, Object-Oriented Programming (OOP)

Tools & AI-Assisted Development:

Git, GitHub, npm, Vite, Webpack, Postman, Chrome DevTools, JIRA, Prompt Engineering, Claude for prototyping/debugging, critical evaluation of AI-generated code, LLM API integration

Education

Accredited Certificate | Full-stack Development

Graduated 05/2025

Turing School of Software and Design | Denver, CO

B.A. in Mathematics | Minor in Computer Science

Graduated 12/2022

Metropolitan State University of Denver | Denver, CO

Projects

Portfolio

[Live Site](#) | [FE Repo](#)

Technologies: Vue.js 3, TypeScript, Vite, Vue Router, CSS, AWS (Amplify), GitHub Pages, JSON data services (migrating to Rails backend)

Modern portfolio site showcasing technical projects through interactive galleries, built from scratch while self-teaching Vue.js and TypeScript

- Architected scalable component system with 35+ nested Vue components using Composition API (ref, computed), 2 custom composables for reusable logic, and extensive TypeScript types for type safety and maintainability
- Implemented data services pattern with 9+ utility files to manage application state from JSON files, establishing clean separation of concerns and API-ready architecture for planned Rails backend integration
- Implemented responsive layouts across mobile, tablet, and desktop, with meticulous attention to consistent element alignment and visual stability from page to page
- Developed with Vite build tooling and Vue Router for navigation, deployed to AWS and GitHub Pages with automated CI/CD

Tracker

[Live Site](#) | [BE Repo](#) | [FE Repo](#)

Technologies: React.js, TypeScript, Tailwind CSS, Ruby on Rails, PostgreSQL, API Integration (TipTap), Cypress, RSpec, CI/CD (CircleCI)

Job tracking application that organizes contacts, target companies, and application status in a centralized dashboard

- Refactored 5+ frontend components to establish consistent design system, resolved 10+ UI bugs, and optimized codebase with isolated interfaces to improve maintainability and code quality
- Leveraged Claude to navigate TipTap's complex API documentation and debug challenging mouse event propagation issues while learning TypeScript—using AI to understand event defaults, troubleshoot WYSIWYG behavior triggers, and develop solutions, then testing and refining implementations through hands-on experimentation
- Conducted 15+ code reviews for team members, providing constructive feedback on React component architecture, TypeScript typing, and Rails API design patterns while maintaining 90%+ test coverage
- Automated deployment pipeline using CircleCI and GitHub Actions, enabling continuous delivery to Heroku with zero-downtime deployments and automated testing

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RepRadar

[Live Site](#) | [BE Repo](#) | [FE Repo](#)

Technologies: React.js, CSS, Ruby on Rails, PostgreSQL, API Integration (5Calls API, Federal Register API), Cypress, RSpec

Web application that helps users stay informed about executive orders and connect with their representatives using zip code search; includes AI-powered scraper that generates executive order summaries from PDF documents

- Engineered React frontend with 20+ reusable components and WCAG-compliant design, implementing cross-browser compatibility and responsive layouts to ensure accessibility across devices
- Built 10+ Rails API endpoints that consolidated data from multiple third-party sources (5Calls, Federal Register) behind a unified gateway layer, normalizing responses into a consistent format for the frontend and persisting user favorites in a dedicated database table
- Led daily code reviews and pair programming sessions, debugging complex issues and strengthening team collaboration while maintaining 95%+ test coverage across backend and frontend

Experience

Independent Tutor | Dragonfly Education | Boulder, CO 11/2025 - Present

- Break down complex mathematical concepts into clear, accessible explanations tailored to each student's level, strengthening understanding and engagement
- Adapt lessons in real time to students' needs, questions, and interests, adjusting approach on the spot to keep material clicking
- Collaborate with parents and teachers to assess needs and build customized, student-centered curricula that improve outcomes
- Run all operations of an independent tutoring practice, including scheduling, curriculum development, and client management

Student Teacher | Denver Public Schools | Denver, CO 08/2017 - 12/2019

- Collaborated with teachers and administrators to analyze student performance data and deliver 50+ technical lessons, translating complex mathematical concepts into accessible knowledge for diverse learners